

Applications of Ethical Reasoning to Social Problems

Ethical reasoning is a decision-making process in which a person decides what is right and wrong by considering the benefits, harms, rights, duties, and possible consequences of an action.

Examples of Application

A. Gender Pay Gap

- Ethical reasoning can be used to examine whether men and women receive fair pay for similar work. **Justice and fairness** are considered while developing policies for equal pay.

B. Environmental Pollution

- Environmental ethics considers the protection of the environment and the well-being of **future generations**. Ethical reasoning can be used to examine the effects of pollution and choose responsible actions.

Ethical Reasoning in Modern Social Problems

Ethical reasoning is also useful for modern problems such as:

- **Global challenges** – balancing the well-being of future generations with environmental protection.
- **Artificial Intelligence** – considering ethical issues related to AI while supporting technological development.
- **Economic inequality** – examining whether government policies provide fair opportunities and reduce inequality.
- **Biotechnology** – considering ethical questions related to genetic editing and human augmentation.

How Ethical Reasoning is Applied to Social Problems

01

Identify the Social Problem

Clearly understand and define the social problem (e.g., poverty, inequality, discrimination, environmental damage). Recognize the real issues and the people affected.

02

Analyse Ethical Dimensions

Study the impact of the problem on individuals, communities and society. Consider fairness, rights, responsibilities and the common good.

03

Apply Ethical Principles

Use ethical principles such as respect for autonomy, beneficence, non-maleficence, justice, fairness and compassion while examining possible solutions.

04

Consider Conflicting Values

Identify different and conflicting values (e.g., economic development vs. environmental protection). Balance the competing concerns in a fair way.

05

Make an Ethical Decision

Examine different options and consider the benefits, harms, rights and responsibilities of each option. Choose the solution that is guided by ethical principles.

06

Take Action

Work for positive social change. Individuals and communities can take responsible action to address the problem.

07

Evaluate and Reflect

Check the effectiveness and ethical impact of the solution. Make improvements if needed.

08

Promote Ethical Leadership and Collaboration

Build a culture of honest behaviour, accountability and mutual respect. Work together with others to create long-term and positive change in society.

Social Discrimination

Social discrimination means treating individuals or groups **unfairly or differently based on their social identity or characteristics**.

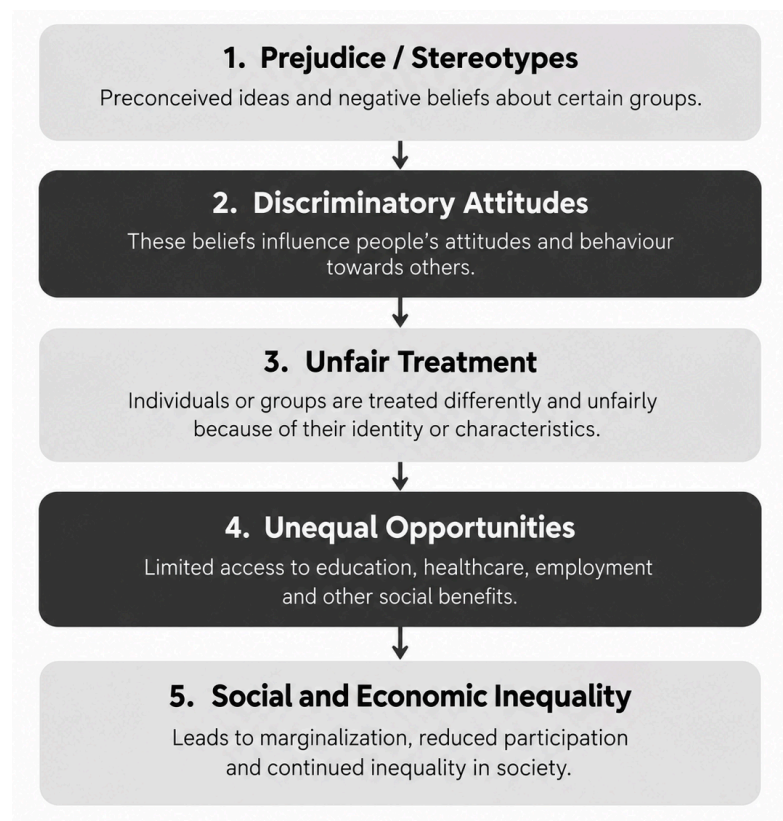
It may affect a person's access to **education, healthcare, employment, opportunities, and other social benefits**.

Social discrimination occurs when people are treated differently because of factors such as:

- Age
- Gender
- Race
- Religion
- Social or economic status
- Other social characteristics

It can create **unequal opportunities** and affect the social and economic development of individuals and communities.

Key Aspects of Social Discrimination



Causes of Social Discrimination

1. Prejudice and Stereotypes

- Preconceived ideas and stereotypes about certain social groups can create discriminatory attitudes. These attitudes can influence people's behaviour toward others.

2. Structural Inequality

- Social, economic, and political systems may create unequal opportunities. Some groups may have fewer resources and opportunities than others.

3. Cultural Norms and Values

- Cultural beliefs and social norms can sometimes favour particular groups. This may result in discrimination against marginalized groups.

4. Historical Factors

- Historical injustices, colonialism, and other forms of oppression can have long-term effects. These effects can continue to influence social relationships and contribute to discrimination.

Effects of Social Discrimination

Social discrimination can result in:

- **Unequal opportunities**
- Limited access to **education**
- Limited access to **healthcare**
- Unequal **employment opportunities**
- Social and economic inequality
- Marginalization of certain groups
- Reduced participation in society

These effects can make existing social inequalities more difficult to reduce.

Ways to Reduce Social Discrimination

The **constitutional protection and policies** as methods for addressing discrimination.

1. Constitutional Protection

Constitutions can protect the **basic rights and freedoms** of individuals, such as equality, privacy, free speech, assembly, and religion.

2. Legal Framework

Laws and regulations can protect individuals from discrimination and provide mechanisms to address violations of rights.

3. Equality Policies

Governments can introduce policies and programmes to address historical and systemic inequalities and provide equal opportunities.

4. Social Welfare Programmes

Social welfare programmes can improve access to **education, healthcare, housing, and social services**, helping reduce poverty and social exclusion.

5. Freedom of Information Laws

Such laws promote **transparency and accountability** and help people access information about government activities.

Inclusive Practices

Inclusive practices refer to **strategies, policies, and actions that create an environment where everyone feels accepted, respected, valued, and included**, regardless of their background or personal characteristics.

Inclusive practices aim to ensure that all individuals get **equal opportunities** and can participate fully in society.

They recognize and respect differences such as:

- Gender
- Age
- Religion
- Race
- Social and economic status
- Other individual differences

The main aim is to create a **fair, respectful, and welcoming environment** for everyone.

Importance of Inclusive Practices

Inclusive practices are important because they:

1. **Respect diversity** among individuals.
2. Create a **welcoming environment**.
3. Provide **equal opportunities**.
4. Help reduce **discrimination and bias**.
5. Promote **empathy and understanding**.
6. Encourage the participation of everyone in society.
7. Support a fair and respectful social environment.

Key Elements of Inclusive Practices

1. Understand Diversity

2. Create Inclusive Environment
3. Provide Equal Opportunities
4. Challenge Discrimination & Bias
5. Provide Education & Training
6. Inclusive Society

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Gender bias means treating people differently or unfairly based on their **gender**. It can create unequal opportunities for men and women in areas such as **education, employment, healthcare, politics, and social life**.

Gender Bias and Issues

Gender bias and related issues can be seen in different areas of society.

1. Economic Opportunities

- Women may face **wage gaps** and occupational segregation.
- They may have limited access to economic opportunities compared with men.
- Gender stereotypes can influence the type of work considered suitable for women.
- Women may also be under-represented in leadership positions.

2. Education

- Gender disparities can exist in access to education.
- Girls may face problems such as **limited access to schooling, gender-based violence, and cultural barriers**.
- These problems can reduce their educational opportunities.

3. Healthcare

- Women may face gender bias in healthcare.
- It can result in differences in **medical treatment, diagnosis, and access to healthcare services**.

4. Violence Against Women

Gender-based violence includes:

- **Domestic violence**

- **Sexual violence**
- **Human trafficking**

Such violence can cause serious physical, emotional, and social problems.

5. Political Representation

- Women may be under-represented in political leadership.
- Limited participation can reduce their representation in political decision-making.

6. Media Representation

- The media can influence how gender roles are understood in society.
- **Objectification, sexualization, and limited representation** can reinforce gender stereotypes.

7. Legal Rights

- Even when legal protections exist, gender-related issues may continue.
- These can include problems related to **property rights and inheritance laws**.

Gender Violence

Gender violence refers to violence or harmful behaviour directed at a person because of their gender. In the notes, examples include **domestic violence, sexual violence, and human trafficking**.

Major Forms of Gender Violence

1. Domestic Violence

- Violence or abuse within the home or family.
- It can affect the physical and emotional well-being of women.

2. Sexual Violence

- Unwanted or forced sexual behaviour.
- It is a serious violation of a person's rights and dignity.

3. Human Trafficking

- Women and girls may become victims of trafficking and exploitation.
- This can seriously affect their freedom, safety, and well-being.

4. Child Marriage

- Early marriage can expose girls to a higher risk of **domestic violence**.
- It can also limit their **autonomy and opportunities**.

5. Dowry System

- The dowry system has historical roots and can create **financial burdens** on women's families.
- It can contribute to violence and discrimination against women.

Measures to Address Gender Bias and Violence

1. Equal Opportunities: Give **equal chances** in education, jobs, healthcare, and politics.

2. Education and Awareness: Create awareness about **gender equality** and remove wrong gender beliefs.

3. Legal Protection: Use **laws** to prevent discrimination and protect people from gender violence.

4. Social Welfare: Provide **education, healthcare, housing, and social support** to reduce inequality.

5. Change Harmful Practices: Identify and change **social and cultural practices** that cause discrimination or violence.